

UK Competitor Analysis

Peer-to-peer driveway and private parking marketplaces: what they offer, where they fall short, and where ParkSpace can win.

Prepared for stakeholders · 2 October 2026 · Working name: ParkSpace (placeholder brand) · Launch market: United Kingdom (GBP)

1. Executive summary

- **The market is led by two well-reviewed marketplaces**, JustPark and YourParkingSpace, with Parklet focused on longer lets. Both leaders have strong driver ratings (about 4.5 out of 5 on Trustpilot), so the opening is *not* basic booking. It is the pain points around the booking.
- **The most repeated complaints are about reliability and recourse**: hosts cancelling or deactivating listings at short notice, drivers arriving to find the space taken, refunds that are hard to get, and slow support.
- **ParkSpace's differentiators** (all already built in the working proof of concept): an instant full refund when a space is blocked, price negotiation, paid extras (CCTV, EV charging matched to the driver's connector), request-to-book with a card hold, a structured overstay flow, and a disputes desk with payout freezing. None of these were visible on the competitor pages reviewed.
- **The biggest commercial risk is price to hosts**. ParkSpace's planned 20% host commission is far above what JustPark reportedly charges hosts (about 3%) and what YourParkingSpace charges hosts (3%, with its own 20% uplift added to the driver's price instead). On identical pricing, hosts would earn less with ParkSpace.
- **Recommendation**: launch in one dense area, lead with reliability ("guaranteed space or full refund"), and decide the commission model before launch (see section 7).

2. Scope and method

Desk research on 2 October 2026 using public web pages: the competitors' own host and driver pages, Trustpilot review pages, UK money-advice sites, and driver-survey write-ups. Fee figures marked "third-party" come from write-ups rather than the company's own terms and **should be confirmed against current terms before external use**. "Not seen" means the feature was not on the pages read; it does not prove the feature is absent. Adjacent players (section 5) are summarised from general knowledge plus survey results and were not researched in depth.

3. Direct competitors

3.1 JustPark: the market leader

What they offer

- Free to list; hourly, daily or monthly rentals; date blocking and set hours
- Manual or automated pricing, including scheduled peak pricing
- Automatic payouts; mobile app for remote management
- Driver verification by number plate; optional property-damage protection
- Polished driver app with reminders and reviews; roughly 4.5 stars on Trustpilot
- Full refund when the driver cancels more than 24 hours ahead; the transaction fee is refunded if the owner or JustPark cancels

Gaps and complaints

- **Host cancellations:** reviews describe owners deactivating listings the night before, with JustPark calling it outside its control
- **Space occupied:** arriving to find the space taken, with no refund for extra costs
- **Refunds:** some customers say they were hard to obtain even when entitled
- **Liability:** the driver agreement puts responsibility for the vehicle on the driver and caps JustPark's liability at the greater of the amount paid or £100
- **Not seen on host pages:** price negotiation, paid extras, request-to-book, a host-side cancellation policy

Fees: hosts pay a small service fee. A third-party guide puts it at about 3%, higher on a first long booking, plus a 50p fee on small withdrawals (*unconfirmed on JustPark's own pages*). Drivers pay a transaction fee; its size is not stated in the driver agreement.

3.2 YourParkingSpace

What they offer

- Highest-rated UK parking app in one survey (4.6/5); Trustpilot about 4.5 across roughly 110,000 reviews
- Wide supply: driveways, garages, commercial and residential car parks, even empty land
- Free to list; hosts keep 100% of their own price less a 3% processing fee
- The driver sees the host's price plus a 20% uplift, which funds marketing and growth

Gaps and complaints

- **Support speed:** one reviewer reports almost four weeks to resolve a parking issue
- **Booking friction:** owners not responding, bookings declined, confirmation problems
- **Refunds:** a reviewer had refund requests rejected twice and was quoted £0 for a cancellation under 24 hours
- **Arrival:** unclear signage and wrong directions to the exact spot
- **Not seen:** negotiation, paid extras, an overstay prompt to the host

3.3 Parklet

What they offer

- Established in 2004; 20,000+ spaces; used by councils and national car-park operators
- Strong in monthly and weekly lets, including residential bays
- Fees: 20% + VAT (monthly, plus a £37.50 + VAT first-month admin fee), 25% + VAT (1–12 weeks), 30% + VAT (1–6 days)

Gaps

- High commission, especially on short lets
- Built for long contracts, not "park for two hours now"
- Older, listing-style product rather than an app-first, on-demand experience

4. Fee comparison

Platform	What the host pays	What the driver pays	Net effect for a host
JustPark	About 3% (third-party figure)	Price plus a transaction fee (amount not stated)	Keeps roughly 97%
YourParkingSpace	3% processing fee	Host price plus a 20% uplift	Keeps about 97% of own price
Parklet	20–30% + VAT, plus admin fee on monthly lets	Listed price	Keeps 70–80% minus VAT on commission
ParkSpace (planned)	20% of the booking total	Listed price, no service fee	Keeps 80%

Why this matters: two competitors take most of their revenue from drivers or take very little from hosts. A 20% host cut makes ParkSpace the more expensive option for hosts, so supply (the hardest thing to build) would be harder to win. This is a business decision for stakeholders, not an engineering one.

5. Adjacent players (same driver, different job)

Player	What they do	Gap relative to a driveway marketplace
RingGo / PayByPhone	Pay for on-street and council parking; RingGo covers 450+ UK councils	Not a booking marketplace and no private spaces. Rated about 3.4 and 3.1 in one survey, with complaints about errors and failed payments.
Parkopedia / AppyParking	Discovery and price information for car parks	Mostly information rather than a place to book. Rated about 3.9 and 3.4, with reviews citing inconsistent payments and bugs.

NCP, APCOA, Q-Park

Operator-owned car parks

Often full or expensive in busy areas. Fixed supply and no peer-to-peer pricing.

6. Feature comparison

ParkSpace column = built and tested in the proof of concept. Competitor columns = visible on the pages reviewed; "Not seen" is not proof of absence.

Capability	ParkSpace (POC)	JustPark	YourParkingSpace
Instant book	Yes	Yes	Yes
Request-to-book with card hold	Yes	Not seen	Owner approval mentioned in reviews
Price negotiation (offer / counter)	Yes	Not seen	Not seen
Paid extras (CCTV, EV charging, valet)	Yes, admin-managed	Not seen	Not seen
EV charging matched to vehicle connector	Yes	Not seen	Not seen
Instant refund if space is blocked	Yes	Complaints of no refund	Not seen
Host-cancellation = full refund + host warning	Yes	Refund yes; recurrence handling not seen	Not seen
Overstay flow (host check, then hourly fee)	Yes	Event-parking call-out fees only	Not seen
Disputes desk, payout freeze, audit log	Yes	Support team	Slow resolution reported
In-app chat	Yes	Not seen	Not seen
Weekly hours and blocked dates	Yes	Yes	Yes
Damage protection / insurance	Not yet (legal advice needed)	Optional protection	Not seen
Real payments, email / SMS / push	Simulated in POC	Live	Live
Supply / network size	Demo data only	Large	Large

7. Opportunities and recommendations

Where ParkSpace can differentiate

- **"Space guaranteed or full refund."** Directly answers the top complaint against both leaders. The mechanism already exists in the product.
- **Negotiation and extras** create value for both sides (hosts fill quiet hours; drivers get better prices and add-ons) and are not visible at the leaders.
- **Faster, clearer resolution.** Support speed is a recurring complaint; the admin disputes tools, payout freezing and audit trail are a ready-made operating model.
- **On-demand short stays** where Parklet is weakest.

Decisions needed before launch

- **Commission model.** Options: (a) keep 20% from hosts, (b) charge hosts a low fee and add a visible driver service fee, or (c) a blended model with a lower launch rate for early hosts. The platform's commission setting is already editable by admin.
- **Liability and insurance.** Competitors disclaim vehicle liability or offer optional damage protection. Obtain legal advice and decide on an insurance partner.
- **Launch area.** Network density decides this market. Pick one city or borough and recruit host supply there first.
- **Payments and notifications.** Move from simulated to Stripe Connect and real email / SMS / push before any public pilot.

8. Risks

- **Incumbent network effects:** JustPark and YourParkingSpace already hold the supply and the brand trust of tens of thousands of reviews.
- **Host economics:** a 20% cut may make recruiting hosts expensive (see section 4).
- **Trust and safety:** blocked-space and host-cancellation problems appear across the sector; reliability must be proven in practice, not just in the product design.
- **Data confidence:** fee figures marked third-party should be verified before they appear in investor or partner material.

9. Sources

- [JustPark: rent out your driveway](#)
- [JustPark driver agreement](#)
- [JustPark reviews on Trustpilot](#)
- [Renting Out Your Driveway in the UK \(Better Income Guide\)](#)
- [UK drivers reveal the best and worst parking apps \(TechRound\)](#)
- [How to list your parking space \(YourParkingSpace\)](#)
- [YourParkingSpace reviews on Trustpilot](#)
- [ParkLet fees and commission](#)
- [ParkLet: about us](#)

Review quotes are paraphrased from public reviews and represent individual customer experiences, not verified facts about every booking.